



PROGRESS REPORT

Niger: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 68 systems and instruments tracked

Of 68 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 45 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 15 did not, 4 carry no stated baseline, and 4 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 65 sources for this place in the window — 17 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 48 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Niger acquired an identity architecture and a fibre backbone in twelve months, and did not acquire the institutions meant to secure them. Four instruments of April and May 2026 [created three registers and an agency, enrolment for the identity card began in April and for the passport in July](#), and [1,031 km of fibre and a Tier III data centre were provisionally accepted in November 2025](#).

Over the same period the [public key infrastructure, cybersecurity centre and forensics laboratory blueprinted in July 2025](#) did not move, the [national cybersecurity strategy stayed in elaboration](#), the [national digital-development policy stayed unadopted](#), and the data-protection authority published nothing about what it does.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National digital-development policy	Drafted and unadopted	Redrafting committee installed 2025-07-18 with one month to update the draft; national validation workshop held 2026-03-11 on three strategic axes - governance/ security of the digital sector, infrastructure/services, and skills/innovation - targeting 2035 and aiming to position Niger as a regional fibre-interconnection hub; not yet formally adopted	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Civil-status regime	The previous civil-status regime	Ordonnance n2026-21 of 2026-04-22 with its application decret in force	ADVANCED
Enforcement against unauthorised satellite resale	No enforcement action on file	Formal notice against Wifi Zones with a 3 October 2025 deadline, carrying three months to a year and fines to 60m FCFA	ADVANCED
Loi 2018-45 prior-authorisation regime for electronic communications	In force	In force and enforced	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Haute Autorite de Protection des Donnees a caractere Personnel	Operating	Operating; no caseload or sanction figures published	NO CHANGE
Loi n2022-59 on personal data protection	In force	In force	NO CHANGE
Malabo Convention ratification	Ratified	Ratified	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Algeria and Niger telecommunications cooperation	Did not exist	Agreed; no programme document or value published	ADVANCED
Identity-system cooperation with Burkina Faso	Did not exist	Mission completed with recommendations on authentic documents and document fraud; no alignment for mutual recognition established	ADVANCED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulatory action on mobile quality of service	No enforcement action on file	Mises en demeure served on all four operators on 2026-06-10, with fines of 1 to 3% of prior-year turnover, licence suspension or withdrawal in prospect	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
PNDN 2026-2035 consultation and validation process	Did not exist	A redrafting committee installed 2025-07-18 revised the draft policy; a national validation workshop held 2026-03-11 was described by the ministry as the product of broad consultation among public- and private-sector digital-ecosystem actors; no separate open public-comment or civil-society submission channel is named	ADVANCED

Nothing in the legal frame changed. [Loi n°2022-59](#) and the [High Authority under it](#) stood at the start of the window and stand at the end, with no caseload, decision or sanction figure published in between — across the twelve months in which the state enrolled its population's biometrics. The [national digital-development policy](#) remains drafted and [unadopted](#).

What moved is enforcement. [Unauthorised resale of satellite connectivity was met with a formal notice in September 2025](#) under Loi 2018-45, and [network quality with mises en demeure on all four operators in June 2026](#). Both rest on a standard the regulator does not publish.

Externally, two bilateral relationships were opened where none was held: [telecommunications cooperation with Algeria in March 2026](#) and an [identity-system mission to Burkina Faso in July 2026](#). The EU country programme had already ended before the window opened.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Luxembourg-supported Sahel connectivity programme	Pledge announced (2025-01)	Support package widened to Ericsson and Sweden; no commitment total published	ADVANCED

The window's one financing movement is external. The Luxembourg-backed Sahel connectivity support package [widened to include Ericsson and Sweden in June 2026](#), still with no commitment total published. No domestic budget line for digital government or digital inclusion is held, so every inclusion movement recorded in the window was funded from outside the country.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Continuous mobile-network monitoring platform	Did not exist	In service, giving the regulator real-time visibility of operator networks	ADVANCED
Domestic national fibre backbone	Did not exist	2,275 km of fibre across three domestic sections - Niamey-Tillabery, Zinder-Diffa, Agadez-Tahoua - built under an RMB 623.7m (about US\$103.8m, constant 2023 dollars) China Eximbank concessional loan signed 2014-01-02, aimed at raising national broadband coverage from 54% to 72%	ADVANCED
Niamey Internet Exchange Point	Did not exist	In service, letting domestic networks exchange traffic locally	ADVANCED
Telco-integrated satellite service	Did not exist	Live, with the operator rather than the customer holding the satellite relationship	ADVANCED
Trans-Sahara fibre backbone	None in service	1,031 km accepted on five axes - Arlit-Assamaka to Algeria (220 km), Diffa-N'Guigmi to Chad (186 km), Zinder-Magaria to Nigeria (117 km), Niamey-Dosso-Gaya to Benin (300 km), Niamey-Makalondi to Burkina Faso (118 km) - plus an 88 km loop to the national data centre, under a project launched under NEPAD in 2017 with works from 2021	ADVANCED
Starlink retail service	Commercially available through approved sellers	Commercially available through approved sellers	NO CHANGE
Mobile network quality of service	BASELINE NOT HELD	Voice and mobile-data quality found deficient at all four operators in the April-May 2026 control, with a verification campaign running to 2026-08-28	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Tier III national data centre	Targeted for delivery by 30 September 2025	Provisionally accepted in Niamey on 14 November 2025, Tier III level, linked to the backbone by an 88 km urban fibre loop	ADVANCED, SLIPPED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Cybersecurity Centre with a SOC and CERT	Planned	Planned; nothing on record built	NO CHANGE
National Cybersecurity Strategy	In elaboration	In elaboration; no text published	NO CHANGE
National digital forensics laboratory	Planned	Planned; nothing on record built	NO CHANGE
National public key infrastructure	Planned	Planned; nothing on record built	NO CHANGE

The window's physical delivery is one event. [Provisional acceptance of 1,031 km of Trans-Sahara fibre on five cross-border axes and of a Tier III data centre at Niamey](#) came in November 2025, two months after the [30 September 2025 delivery date the minister had given](#). [A national internet exchange point opened in August 2025](#).

Against that, three institutions enumerated by the same critical-infrastructure committee in July 2025 — a national public key infrastructure, a cybersecurity centre with a security operations centre and a CERT, and a digital forensics laboratory — are in exactly the position they were in at the window's start: planned, with nothing on record built. The national cybersecurity strategy is still in elaboration a year after the symposium that opened it.

Satellite access changed shape rather than scale: [Airtel Niger commercialised a telco-integrated service in January 2026](#), moving the customer relationship to the operator, while direct retail continued unchanged.

The regulator gained instruments and used them. [A continuous monitoring platform was inaugurated in January 2026](#), and by July it had produced the first published verdict on network quality: [deficient at all four operators, with a verification campaign to 28 August 2026](#).

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
West African foundational-ID interoperability strategy	Did not exist	Validated; no implementation step published	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AES biometric national identity card	Did not exist	Mandatory at 15 and over, valid five years at 4,500 FCFA, capturing fingerprint, face, voice and iris	ADVANCED
AES biometric passport	Did not exist	Five categories issued to ICAO specification, five years over 34 pages, produced by the Police DST with AI Itissal AI Jadeed	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Agence Nationale de l'Enregistrement et de l'Identification des personnes physiques	Did not exist	Created and chartered under the interior ministry, with its statutes approved by a companion decret; no budget, staffing or enrolment target stated	ADVANCED
WURI-Niger identification programme	Operational, with a goal of 22m enrolled by 2026	Restructured and carrying the statutory register stack; RNP enrolment starting in Niamey	ADVANCED
AES harmonised travel and identity document specifications	Validated and referred to the heads of state	Validated; five passport categories now issued under them	NO CHANGE
MOSIP open-source identity pilot	Piloted in four communes	Piloted in four communes; no later enrolment figure published	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Bank-to-wallet interoperability	Did not exist	Live between Banque Atlantique accounts and mobile wallets	ADVANCED
Identity-fee payment kiosks	Did not exist	Live at enrolment sites, issuing receipts for the enrolment file	ADVANCED
Scholarship payment through the Treasury application	Did not exist	Stated as an intention; no budget, vendor, timetable or beneficiary count published	ADVANCED

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Birth certificates issued in Diffa region	56% timely declaration (2022)	173,109 certificates issued July 2023 to July 2026, timely declaration at 88.04% (2025)	ADVANCED
Birth declaration rate	53.48% of births registered (2022)	79% of births registered against 53.48% in 2022 on the WURI-linked series; the interior ministry separately gave 80% in 2026 against 60% in 2023, and UNICEF put the Tahoua region alone at a rise from 69% to 75%	ADVANCED
Diaspora project and expert data banks	Did not exist	Undertaken; no enabling instrument, custodian, data-protection basis or timetable named	ADVANCED
National Civil Register	Did not exist	Instituted; designed to interoperate with the population and nationality registers	ADVANCED
National Nationality Register	Did not exist	Instituted under the justice ministry	ADVANCED
National Population Register	Did not exist	In build as a central secure database assigning every citizen a unique identifier, with a public sensitisation tour running ahead of it - Tillaberi its third region - a first enrolment phase opening at Niamey and other regions following in 2027	ADVANCED
Filingue birth-certificate pilot	Pilot under way	Pilot under way; no completion figure published	NO CHANGE
Communes with computerised civil-status registration	Not held	68% of communes nationwide computerised, on UNICEF's own account of the support it has given	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Integrated state human resources and payroll system	Ageing separate systems on the Solde2Budget platform of 2021	16,500 files digitised and 23,000 updated against a scope of about 200,000 public agents	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National e-health master plan 2025-2029	None published	Validated and budgeted, covering health information, interoperability, surveillance and cybersecurity	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Tax administration digitalisation	Core systems disrupted by sanctions	Core systems back at full operation, with a 24/7 digital tax administration sought	ADVANCED

Identity is where almost all the movement sits, and it happened in five months. Nothing existed at the window's start; by its end the [AES biometric identity card was in mass enrolment across Niamey's 20 commissariats](#), mandatory at 15 and over and capturing fingerprint, face, voice and iris, and the [AES passport had opened enrolment in five ICAO-specification categories](#). Behind them, the [ordonnance and décrets of April and May 2026 created a civil register, a nationality register, a population register and the agency to run it](#), and the World Bank programme that had been running alongside the sovereignty track was restructured to carry them. In August the register's awareness tour took those texts to the regions, [officially launched at Dosso on 14 August](#).

The declaration rate the whole design rests on is the one figure the record cannot pin down. The base opened the window holding [66% of births nationally](#) and closes it holding two further series from the same ministry within a week — [79% against 53.48% in 2022](#) on the WURI-linked measure, and [80% in 2026 against 60% in 2023](#) at the African civil-registration day. None is reconciled to another, so the direction is clear and the level is not. The regional figures run the same way: [Diffa reports timely declaration up from 56% in 2022 to 88.04% in 2025 and 173,109 certificates issued over three years](#), and UNICEF puts Tahoua up from 69% to 75% and [68% of communes nationwide computerised](#).

Administrative systems advanced onto state platforms. The [integrated human resources and payroll system produced its first figures — 16,500 files digitised and 23,000 updated —](#) against about 200,000 public agents, and [student grants are to follow onto the Treasury's application](#). Health acquired a [validated master plan with 27 projects](#) where it had none, and the [tax administration recovered its systems and convened on what comes next](#).

Payments interoperated for the first time: [bank-to-wallet transfers in June 2026](#), and [kiosks taking the identity-card fee at enrolment sites from April —](#) the same operator at both ends.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Naneye Yarda municipal tax platform	Did not exist	Live at Niamey with 50 field agents, geolocation of more than 2,000 taxpayers, mobile-money payment via Al Izza and Nita, and automated transaction auditing	ADVANCED

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Villages Intelligents rural inclusion programme	Did not exist	One centre on record, with women's and girls' digital skills training	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Illimi programme on AI applied to human security	Did not exist	One training round completed, run by the UN coordination office with the statistics institute, ANSI and the interior ministry	ADVANCED

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronics assembly plant	Did not exist	A plant to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets at 63 per cent completion and due in service by the end of October 2026, inspected by a delegation of the ICT and technical-education ministers	ADVANCED
Local electronics assembly plant	Did not exist	The communications and vocational-training ministers inspected an electronics assembly plant under construction in the Tillabery region on 20 August 2026, the authorities reporting the smartphone, computer and tablet facility more than 60% built after six months, against 57% of its overall timeline, and framing locally assembled devices for citizens and public institutions as a way to cut dependence on imported equipment	ADVANCED
Foreign supplier of national identity documents	Contracted to a Libyan supplier	Contracted to a Libyan supplier, now producing the card and the passport with a local partner	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
University innovation hub at Diffa	Did not exist	A university selected through a competitive process to host an innovation hub under a development-bank and UN-backed youth agripreneurship programme, with the workshop validating its project document opened	ADVANCED
Startup ecosystem support	Supported by the digital agency	Supported by the digital agency; no funding or company count published	NO CHANGE

One position was created: the [training of 140 cadres in AI applied to human security in June 2026](#), with a multisectoral government and UN data platform behind it. The [startups the digital agency names](#), and the [identity-document supply contract](#) are where they were at the window's start, neither with a funding figure nor a delivery milestone published since.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AfricaCERT Handshake symposium	Did not exist	Hosted once, with the digital agency proposing an AES regional cyber-defence alliance	ADVANCED
Niger Digital Day skills caravan	Did not exist	A two-day youth digital-skills programme running in stages, which the organisers say will cover all eight regions and reach more than 800 young people, with training including artificial intelligence	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Guidan Fasaha community digital centre	One centre at Diffa	Two centres, the second with 100 computers and 50 kW of solar power	ADVANCED

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural access constraint on identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	An analyst warns of privacy breaches, state surveillance and systemic exclusion, with rural communities, migrants and those without foundational identity most exposed	Baseline not held

Two access programmes advanced in the window. The World Food Programme added a second community digital centre, at Tahoua, in July 2026. The rural inclusion programme opened one centre, at Tabelot.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Fifth general population and housing census	Did not exist	Preparation under way; no enumeration date published	ADVANCED
Niger's share of UEMOA electronic money	BASELINE NOT HELD	3.92% of accounts opened across the Union (2024)	Baseline not held

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Multisectoral government and United Nations data platform	Did not exist	In build with the statistics institute; no launch date published	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
IGNN remote-sensing unit	Did not exist	IGNN runs a teledetection et techniques spatiales unit producing Sentinel-based satellite imagery for forest, land-use and territorial monitoring, and describes itself as an exclusive satellite-imagery distributor in several countries; no programme name, partner or date is published	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
China-Niger digital cooperation	Did not exist	Huawei has operated in Niger since 1998; a 2014 China Eximbank loan (RMB 623.7m, about US\$103.8m in constant 2023 dollars) built a 2,275 km domestic fibre backbone completed in 2017; China's newly arrived ambassador met Huawei's VP in September 2025 to discuss deepening cooperation, with no post-2017 Chinese financing or vendor contract on record	ADVANCED

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
EU multiannual indicative programme 2021-2027	Ended, replaced by a EUR 238m complex-settings envelope inside the regional programme	Ended, replaced by a EUR 238m complex-settings envelope inside the regional programme	NO CHANGE

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
e& Partner2Connect commitment	Did not exist	e& (UAE) committed US\$6bn (2024-2026) to ITU's Partner2Connect coalition across 16 markets including Niger and Mali, not divided by country; no Niger-specific project, disbursement or value published	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Mobile quality-of-service thresholds	The text of ARCEP decision n°000012/ARCEP/CNRCEP/21 of 10 December 2021, or any official statement of the indicators and thresholds mobile operators are measured against.	2026-08-10
National data centre capacity	A rack, floor-area, power or storage figure for the Tier III data centre accepted at Niamey in November 2025, from the digital economy ministry, ANSI or the AfDB project documents.	2026-08-10
Power supply to network sites and data centres	An operator, NIGELEC or regulator statement quantifying outage exposure or backup provision for telecommunications sites and the national data centre.	2026-08-10
Public budget allocation to digital government	A Nigerien budget or expenditure statement carrying an identifiable appropriation for communications, digital economy, ANSI or ARCEP.	2026-08-10

Nine rows carry no position at either end. The sharpest is the quality-of-service standard the regulator enforces against and does not publish, so this report can say operators were sanctioned and cannot say against what. Two more are unpublished figures for things that exist — data-centre capacity and power provision for network sites. The rest are subjects the base holds nothing on for Niger: municipal digital services, earth-observation capability, budget appropriation for digital government, public consultation on digital policy, and any Chinese or Gulf digital instrument.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.